Deep Dive — Stack Wealth

Competitor #2 of the new batch. Built from stackwealth.in, /financial-health-report, /about-us, and the uploaded OTP/pricing screenshots.

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1. What they are

Stack Wealth (legal entities: **StackFin Technology Private Limited** and **Invacia Labs Private Limited**) is a Y Combinator-backed wealth management app targeting India's "emerging affluent" — positioned between mass-retail trackers and Ionic-style private banking. Backed by Y Combinator, Harvard Management, Goodwater Capital, and individual investors including Kunal Shah (CRED) and Tanuj Shori (Squareyards). AMFI-registered MFD (ARN 171554), SEBI RIA (INA000021313). Self-reported legacy: a wealth team managing ₹1,600+ Crore for over 1 lakh investors for 25 years — suggesting Invacia Labs is likely an older advisory business Stack acquired/merged with for its book and regulatory registration, with StackFin as the newer consumer tech layer.

Positioning: full-stack investing app (you invest *through* Stack — stocks, curated stock baskets, mutual funds) with a tracking/review layer (Vault, Financial Health Report) as both a retention tool and a lead-gen funnel into paid advisory tiers. Closer to Kuvera/PowerUp in model than to a pure tracker.

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2. Financial Health Report — their Portfolio Streamliner equivalent

Directly comparable to Ionic Wealth's tool, and confirms the same industry pattern a third time.

Import mechanism: "100% secure via RBI-regulated Account Aggregator. Your data is encrypted, shared only with your consent via OTP, and never stored or misused." The uploaded screenshot confirms the specific vendor: **Finvu** is their AA Technology Service Provider — "Stackfin uses Finvu to safely receive your financial details," explicitly noting joint accounts aren't supported yet and citing "10 Million+ users have used Account Aggregators (AAs)! Supported by: [30+ institution logos]" as a trust signal.

This is genuinely useful, concrete intel: Finvu is one of the handful of RBI-licensed AA "technology service providers" (alongside Setu, Onemoney) that startups actually integrate with rather than building AA compliance from scratch — this is now a specific, named vendor to evaluate when your AA/ARN conversation gets there, not just an abstract framework.

Output: a "Freedom Score™" — risk, returns, diversification, and goal-alignment measured against real-life goals (retirement, home, emergency fund) — followed by a personalised action plan and expert advisor consultation within 48 hours. Same "score + ranked actions + human follow-up" pattern as Ionic Wealth's tool — this is clearly becoming the standard playbook for AA-based lead-gen tools in this market, not a one-off.

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3. Product surface

- **Stocks + "Stacks"**: individually named curated thematic baskets (Pharma Edge, Small is Beautiful, Building India, Flexicap Kings, Golden Sectors, etc.) — a smallcase-style curated-basket investing model, not raw stock picking.
- **Mutual funds**: direct browsing/investing by category (equity/debt/hybrid) plus curated picks.
- **Vault**: described as a "unique feature that provides users with a personalised, objective-based investment plan" — their tracking/goal-planning layer, bundled as part of paid tiers (see pricing below), not a free standalone tracker.
- **Calculators**: an unusually large, SEO-driven set — beyond the standard SIP/SWP/EMI/retirement/PPF/EPF/CAGR calculators, they've built **bank-specific FD and RD calculators** for HDFC, SBI, ICICI, Bank of Baroda, Bank of India, PNB, and Yes Bank individually. This is clearly an organic-search acquisition strategy (each calculator targets a specific high-volume search query like "HDFC FD calculator"), not a product decision — worth noting as a cheap, high-leverage SEO tactic we could replicate for our own calculator suite once built.

4. Pricing (from uploaded screenshot)

Two paid tiers, billed yearly: **Stack One** (~₹2,472/mo, ~₹29,660/yr) and **Stack One Plus** (~₹3,178/mo, ~₹38,135/yr). Both bundle: curated stock baskets, "smart asset allocation based on goals and risk appetite," senior financial advisor support, goal/insurance/tax planning, rebalancing alerts, and reports. **Notably, "track all investments including those from other apps" is a Plus-tier paid feature, not free** — meaning cross-platform portfolio aggregation itself is being sold as a premium add-on here, not given away as table stakes.

This is a real pricing-model data point worth weighing against our earlier competitive analysis finding that "the market has converged on free core tracking." Stack Wealth is the first competitor in this set to explicitly paywall aggregation/tracking rather than treat it as a free acquisition funnel — worth deciding deliberately whether that's evidence of a viable alternative model, or evidence that ~₹30-38k/year is priced for their specific "emerging affluent" segment and not transferable to a mass-market free-tracker positioning.

5. A messaging inconsistency worth noting (not a criticism to repeat, a lesson to avoid)

Their homepage safety section leads with "No Hidden Fees, No Commissions" as a headline trust claim, but the very next line clarifies: "we earn a commission directly from the fund house" on mutual fund distribution (standard regular-plan MFD commission model — same as Mprofit's underlying revenue mechanism, just less visible). This is a real tension in their own copy: "no commissions" and "we earn commission from the fund house" are presented back to back without reconciling them (the honest read is "no *additional* fees to you," but that's not what the headline says). Worth flagging as a trust-copywriting lesson: if we ever monetize via distribution commission, be precise about "no additional cost to you" rather than an unqualified "no commissions" claim that a careful reader will catch as contradictory.

6. Tech/vendor signals

- **AA provider**: Finvu (confirmed, not inferred — direct from product screenshot).
- **CDN**: assets served from `cdn.stackwealth.in`, standard practice, no further backend signal available.
- No public engineering blog or job-posting stack details found in this pass.

7. Strengths and weaknesses (battlecard)

Strengths: strong pedigree (YC + Harvard Management + Goodwater + known angels) lends credibility for fundraising conversations of our own as a reference point; a real 25-year, ₹1,600 Cr legacy advisory book gives them trust depth beyond a typical startup; the SEO-driven bank-specific calculator strategy is cheap, proven, and directly copyable; concrete, named AA vendor (Finvu) removes ambiguity about which TSP to evaluate.

Weaknesses (our openings): tracking/aggregation is paywalled behind a ~₹30-38k/year advisory subscription — a genuinely expensive product for anyone who just wants visibility, not full-service advisory; the "no commissions" messaging has an internal contradiction that erodes trust on close reading; product surface is investing-first (you must invest *through* them to get the full experience), which doesn't serve someone who already holds assets across Zerodha/Groww/etc. and just wants a neutral, non-selling tracker — the same structural gap Ionic Wealth has, from a different price point.

8. Strategic implications for us

1. **Third independent confirmation that AA is production-ready today** (after Passbook.ai and Ionic Wealth) — and now with a named vendor (Finvu) to actually evaluate rather than research from scratch when the ARN/AA conversation resumes.

2. **We should keep tracking free**, not paywalled — Stack Wealth's model validates that a paid tier can exist, but only once you're also monetizing distribution/advisory; as a pure tracker-first product without that revenue engine yet, gating our core value prop behind a subscription would kill adoption before we have anything else to sell.
3. **Copy their calculator SEO playbook** directly — bank-specific FD/RD calculator pages are low-effort, high-search-volume content we can build early, independent of the MF/equity engineering timeline.
4. **Avoid their commission-messaging trap** — if/when we monetize via MFD commission, say "no additional cost to you," not an unqualified "no commissions."
5. **Neither Ionic Wealth nor Stack Wealth actually serves "I already invest everywhere, just show me my numbers neutrally"** — that gap is widening as evidence accumulates, and it's still the core of our positioning.

Third confirmation of production-ready AA, and this time with a named vendor — the screenshot you sent shows Stack Wealth using **Finvu** specifically as their Account Aggregator TSP. That's concrete, evaluable intel (alongside Setu/Onemoney as alternatives) for whenever the ARN/AA conversation resumes — no longer an abstract framework.

A real pricing-model fork worth deciding deliberately: Stack Wealth paywalls cross-platform tracking behind a ~₹30–38k/year advisory subscription rather than giving it away free. That cuts against the "free core tracking" pattern the rest of the competitive set follows. I'd recommend staying free on tracking — Stack Wealth can afford to paywall it because they're also selling advisory and distribution; we don't have that second revenue engine yet, so gating our core value prop would kill adoption before we have anything else to monetize.

A cheap, copyable tactic: their bank-specific FD/RD calculator pages (HDFC FD calculator, SBI FD calculator, etc.) are clearly built for SEO capture on high-volume searches. Low effort, proven, worth adding to the calculator backlog independent of the MF/equity engineering timeline.